

SOC Analyst Tier1 - Candidate Interview Form

1) Applicant Information:

Candidate Name		Education Level	
Interview Date		Work Experience	
Position Applied For	SOC Analyst (Tier 1)	SANS Courses	☐ 301 ☐ 401 ☐ 504 ☐ 503 ☐ 511 ☐ 450 ☐ 555
Interviewer	Hesam Hoseini	Another Courses	☐ Network+ ☐ Security+ ☐ LPIC1 ☐ CEH ☐ Splunk1,2
Contact Information		Relevant Certifications	

2. General Cybersecurity Knowledge (based on SANS SEC 301, 401)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What is the CIA triad, and why is it important?		
Explain the difference between vulnerability, threat, and risk.		
How do you differentiate between a false positive and a true positive?		
What is the role of a SOC Analyst Tier 1 in an organization?		
What is the difference between IDS and IPS?		

3. Compliance and Security Frameworks (based on SANS SEC 440, SANS MGT 512)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What is the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and how is it used?		
Are you familiar with any compliance frameworks (e.g., CIS, GDPR)?		
What is the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, and how is it used?		
How do you ensure systems comply with security baselines (e.g., CIS)?		

4. Security Tools and Technologies (based on SANS SEC 401, 555)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What is a SIEM, and how does it work?		
Name some tools you have used for security monitoring or analysis.		
How would you use SIEM to investigate an alert?		
What tools would you use to analyze logs, and how?		
What steps would you take to tune SIEM alerts to reduce false positives?		

5. Incident Detection and Response (based on SANS SEC 504, 511)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What are the steps in the incident response process?		
How would you handle a malware detection alert?		
What would you do if you observed repeated login failures in logs?		
Describe how you prioritize and escalate alerts.		
Explain the steps in handling a phishing email incident.		
How do you determine if an alert is a false positive?		

6. Threat Intelligence and Analysis (based on SANS SEC 578)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What are IoCs, and how do you identify them?		
How do you use threat intelligence in daily SOC operations?		
Describe the difference between TTPs and IoCs.		

7. Log Analysis (based on SANS SEC 450,555, 503)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
What types of logs would you review to identify a brute-force attack?		
Explain how you'd analyze a firewall log to investigate a suspicious connection.		
How do you identify anomalies in web server logs?		
Explain how you'd detect lateral movement in a network.		
Explain how you'd look for suspicious processes on an endpoint.		

8. Scenario-Based Questions (based on SANS SEC 504)

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
You notice unusual traffic from a user's workstation. What steps do you take?		
An alert indicates a brute force attack. How do you investigate?		
A web server is suspected of being attacked. Describe your response.		
How would you handle a ransomware outbreak?		
A phishing email is reported by an employee. How do you investigate it?		
You receive an alert for an unusual spike in outbound DNS queries from a server. How would you proceed?		

9. Behavioral and Communication Skills

Question	Applicant's Response	Score (1-5)
How do you document and report a security incident?		
How would you explain a technical issue to a non-technical colleague?		
What would you do if you made a mistake during an investigation?		
How do you stay updated on cybersecurity trends and technologies?		
Describe a time when you worked with a team to solve a complex problem.		

10. Overall Assessment

Category	Strengths	Weaknesses	Score (1-5)	Recommendation:
Technical Knowledge				☐ Hire ☐ No Hire ☐ Second Round ☐ Needs Additional Training
Problem-Solving Ability				
Communication Skills				
Attitude and Adaptability				